ACAD FINDER

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Design Thinking

The design thinking process for NOTE NOVA involves five key phases:

Empathize: Students are studied to understand their needs and challenges in accessing reliable academic resources like notes and past papers during exam weeks.

Define: Framing a clear problem statement regarding the difficulty of discovering reliable materials that align with specific course requirements.

Ideate: Creative solutions are brainstormed, including unified taxonomies, peer-vetted systems, and AI-driven discovery tools.

Prototype: Creating mockups of the platform showcasing features like course-specific dashboards and resource filters.

Test: Sharing the prototype with students to gather feedback on usability and ensure a smooth experience during high-pressure study periods.

DEFINE PHASE

The Challenge:

Students face significant challenges in discovering and managing academic resources during high-pressure exam weeks. Current methods of resource sharing—such as unorganized WhatsApp groups, private Google Drive links, and outdated university portals—are fragmented, leading to a "search fatigue" that takes time away from actual learning.

Key Insights:

- Context Gap: Students find notes but cannot verify if they align with their specific course code, professor, or current syllabus version.
- Accessibility Barriers: Resources are often behind "request access" walls or hidden in deep chat histories, making them inaccessible when needed most.
- Quality Variance: There is no centralized system to distinguish between high-quality, verified materials and incomplete or incorrect notes.

Problem Statement

The current academic landscape suffers from a Fragmentation Gap. Scattered Resources: Essential study materials (previous year papers, lecture notes, lab manuals) are buried in WhatsApp groups, Telegram channels, or individual Google Drives.

90% of users consume content, but only 10% contribute, leading to a stale repository over time.

Finding a specific topic (e.g Types of Antenna) within a 200-page PDF of general math notes is time-consuming.

EMPATHY MAP

Says

"Does anyone have the Unit 4 PPT from Professor Sharma's lecture?"
"Is this the 2024 updated syllabus or the old one from 2021?"
"I've been scrolling through this WhatsApp group for 20 minutes and still can't find the PDF."
"I just need a quick summary of this chapter; I don't have time to read 80 pages tonight."

Thinks

"I am wasting more time searching for the materials than actually studying them."
"I hope these notes from my senior are actually what's going to be on the exam."
"Why isn't there one single place where all this stuff is organized?"
"If I fail this, it's because I couldn't find the right resources in time."

Does

Searches through multiple WhatsApp "Media" tabs and starred messages.
Begs classmates or seniors to "Resend" files that were previously shared.
Uses Google or YouTube to find generic explanations because the specific course PPT is missing.

Feels

Anxiety: High pressure from the ticking clock of the exam.
Frustration: Irritated by broken links, "Access Denied" Google Drive folders, and unorganized file names
Relief: A sudden drop in stress when a clear, verified, and organized resource is finally located.

PROBLEM SOLUTION

Students and academic staff face significant challenges in discovering and managing reliable academic resources through existing fragmented systems like social media groups and private storage links.

These inefficiencies lead to:

Time Loss: Significant time spent searching for materials rather than studying.

Communication Gaps: Difficulty in finding the "single source of truth" for a specific course syllabus.

Frustration: Increased stress during exam periods due to unreliable or inaccessible data.

Therefore, there is a need for a user-friendly, efficient, and secure discovery platform that simplifies the academic journey—from discovering course-specific PPTs and notes to accessing verified past papers and quick summaries—while enhancing the overall digital learning experience.

My Experience

In my role , I have helped developers and students architect systems that bridge the gap between static data and active learning. My experience involves:

Information Architecture: Organizing thousands of files so they don't just become a "digital graveyard" of forgotten documents.

User Motivation: Understanding the psychology of why users share or don't share their intellectual property.

What We've Built

The solution is a Centralized, AI-Enhanced Academic Hub designed to be the "GitHub for Students.

- **A structured cloud-based library categorized by University ,Department-Semester-Subject.**
- **We don't just store files; we "read" them.**
- **A peer-review system where students can upvote high-quality notes and flag outdated ones. This ensures the best content rises to the top.**
- **A "One-Click Upload" flow that uses AI to automatically suggest the subject and category of a file based on its content, reducing the effort needed to share.**

FUTURE SCOPE

- Adding vast or bulk amount of resources
- Tracking system- which tracks the student study time
- Smart resources Tagging and search simple
- Interactive doubt session
- Making it more reliable and more accessible students

THANK YOU!